



# Notes

Feb 11, 2026

# Red Hat Account Team Introduction

Invited [Bill Venella](#) [Phillip Eurs](#) [Bill Stoker](#) [Jason Anderson](#) [Sunil Gaddam](#) [Jason Dobyns](#)

Attachments [Red Hat Account Team Introduction](#)

Meeting records [Transcript](#)

## Summary

Bill Venella and Jason Anderson of Red Hat met with Panasonic attendees Phillip Eurs, Jason Dobyns, and Sunil G to understand Panasonic's current mix of RHEL, older CentOS, and Oracle Linux platforms, and their efforts to modernize applications to RHEL 9 and migrate systems to AKS containers and Azure. Panasonic is actively evaluating alternatives to VMware due to licensing costs and is using Ansible and Terraform extensively for deployment automation, while facing challenges in retiring older, unmaintained platforms due to previous engineering decisions and extensive approval processes for migration. Jason Anderson recommended considering RHEL 10 and OpenShift Virtualization as a unified platform for VMs and containers to simplify administration and development, and Jason Dobyns confirmed plans to add RHEL 10 builds soon.

## Details

- **Introductions and Meeting Objective** Bill Venella, working on their tenth year at Red Hat, introduced themselves as part of the new account team for Panasonic, with the goal of better understanding Panasonic's current usage of Red Hat products and providing improved support ([00:00:00](#)). Jason Anderson, a Solutions Architect with almost four years at Red Hat, also introduced themselves and offered to bring in experts if needed. Panasonic attendees included Phillip Eurs, a senior member of the Linux team and media content service team, and Jason Dobyns, who is focused on automation, deployment, and migrating systems to AKS containers ([00:02:26](#)). Sunil G, a system administrator, DevOps cloud engineer, and SRE, also participated in the introductions ([00:03:43](#)).
- **Current Platform Usage and Migration Efforts** Phillip Eurs noted that Panasonic currently uses a mix of RHEL and older CentOS versions, along with some Oracle Linux ([00:02:26](#)). The team is actively working to replace or refactor older applications running on unsupported platforms, like CentOS, to modern

supported platforms such as RHEL 9 ([00:04:54](#)). Jason Dobyns mentioned efforts to containerize some older applications, particularly those requiring older versions of Java, to manage security vulnerabilities until the instances can be retired ([00:06:12](#)).

- **Cloud and Virtualization Strategy** Bill Venella inquired about Panasonic's move to the cloud, to which Jason Dobyns responded that many new VMs are deployed directly in Azure, though some on-prem systems remain for specific network access needs ([00:07:44](#)). Jason Dobyns detailed their use of Packer to create RHEL 9 and RHEL 8 images, storing them both in Azure and on-prem VMware ([00:08:52](#)). Phillip Eurs confirmed that Panasonic is evaluating alternatives to VMware due to licensing costs and the acquisition by Broadcom ([00:10:02](#)).
- **Red Hat's OpenShift and RHEL 10 Recommendations** Bill Venella offered to share Red Hat's point of view on moving off VMware, mentioning recent updates to their approach and highlighting the business opportunity of using OpenShift in the data center to enable lift and shift opportunities and transfer workloads/licensing costs to the cloud, avoiding duplication ([00:10:02](#)). Jason Anderson emphasized the benefits of OpenShift Virtualization as a single platform for VMs and containers, arguing that it simplifies administration and development across environments, unlike AKS which only supports containers ([00:12:21](#)) ([00:14:31](#)). Jason Anderson also strongly encouraged Panasonic to consider RHEL 10 for its new features, such as image mode and the ability to define the OS in a DevOps workflow ([00:16:32](#)). Jason Dobyns confirmed plans to add RHEL 10 builds soon, noting that some current RHEL 8 instances were built due to specific software compatibility requirements ([00:17:35](#)).
- **Automation Tooling and Modernization** Jason Dobyns and Phillip Eurs confirmed that Ansible is a key automation tool, alongside extensive use of Terraform for deployment and standardization of machine setup processes ([00:18:38](#)) ([00:24:03](#)). Jason Dobyns shared that they are working to update Ansible (currently on 2.12) and Terraform to the latest versions ([00:26:22](#)) ([00:28:32](#)). Jason Anderson suggested exploring the integration of Ansible and Terraform, which is supported in AAP 2.6, and offered to set up further meetings on AAP's new features, including AI integration and event-driven automation ([00:25:10](#)) ([00:27:26](#)).
- **Challenges in Modernization** Phillip Eurs explained that the team faces challenges from previous engineering decisions leading to the persistence of older, unmaintained platforms, including RHEL 8, due to a past culture of engineers developing their own systems without proper controls ([00:20:49](#)). Jason Dobyns noted that older systems, especially those supporting in-flight entertainment, require extensive approval processes before migration, contributing to the slower pace of updates ([00:21:56](#)). The team is actively working on internal processes to continuously update tooling and platforms, aiming to improve cyber security scores by leveraging containers on newer platforms for easier system replacement and updates ([00:30:11](#)).

- **Next Steps and Partnership Commitment** Bill Venella committed to a tighter partnership, proposing to establish consistent meeting cadence and further understand Panasonic's architecture and goals to help them maximize value from Red Hat products ([00:32:31](#)). Phillip Eurs agreed to set up a regular, likely monthly, cadence, noting that licensing renewal is upcoming and Panasonic is not planning to reduce its Red Hat footprint ([00:33:41](#)). Phillip Eurs also mentioned that their manager, Bill Stoker, would ideally join future meetings to offer strategic insights ([00:34:50](#)). The Red Hat team agreed to share notes, information on OpenShift versions, and a white paper on alternatives to VMware after the meeting ([00:12:21](#)) ([00:34:50](#)). The Panasonic team is primarily based in Irvine, California, and Bill Venella expressed interest in visiting in the future to further build the relationship ([00:34:50](#)).

## Suggested next steps

Jason Anderson will share the notes with everybody and send an updated white paper or portal site regarding the alternative hypervisors to Phillip Eurs shortly after the meeting.

Jason Anderson will add information about the different flavors of Open Shift to the next meeting agenda so the group can be more informed about the various acronyms.

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# Transcript

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# Red Hat Account Team Introduction - Transcript

00:00:00

**Jason Anderson:** Oops. All right. Sorry everybody. I'm taking uh some notes here. So, uh Gemini Gemini is doing it.

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah.

**Jason Anderson:** I can share with everybody afterwards if if you like. Um just helps remember everything.

**Bill Venella:** Yeah. So, thanks for setting this up, Jason.

**Jason Anderson:** All right. You want to kick it off, Bill?

**Bill Venella:** Yeah. So, you know, I think uh I think we had a brief intro uh upon Brad leaving. Oh, here there's somebody else. There were a bunch of others. Oh, did we lose him? Oh,

**Phillip Eurs:** Where's our Jason?

**Bill Venella:** there he is.

**Phillip Eurs:** There he

**Bill Venella:** Hey, Jason.

**Jason Dobyns:** Hi

**Phillip Eurs:** is.

**Bill Venella:** Good afternoon.

**Jason Dobyns:** guys.

**Bill Venella:** Good afternoon. Oh, I like the red shirt.

**Jason Dobyns:** Thank

**Bill Venella:** Well, uh,

**Jason Dobyns:** you.

**Bill Venella:** greetings everybody, uh, from the new account team. All right. So, uh, Jason set this up just to make introductions, right?

00:01:11

**Bill Venella:** Our goal here is, you know, just to get a better understanding of, uh, your

current usage of of Red Hat and seeing what we can do to, uh, to better support you, right? Uh, and I'm sure you've heard the commercial, right? We have three pillars, re, anible, uh, you know, RA from a platform perspective. Anible from an automation perspective and then you know we have a hybrid container solution. Um but I didn't want uh I didn't want this to be a commercial. I wanted to be a two-way conversation. Right. So I'll start off and just begin right uh Bill Vanella. I've been with uh this this I'm working on my 10th year at Red Hat. Hopefully I can make it to the end of the year. uh that'll be 10 years. Uh I've worked with some of our biggest most strategic accounts and uh so I picked up Panasonic at the beginning of the year. So definitely looking forward to working with you guys and uh figuring out how to uh to better support you.

00:02:26

**Phillip Eurs:** Nice to meet you. Thank you.

**Jason Anderson:** Um, and I'll jump in real quick. I'm Jason Anderson. I'll be the solutions architect supporting Panasonic and Bill. Um, I've been with Red Hat almost four years now. Before that, I spent 15 years, uh, doing research and development for the FAA, maintaining their systems. So, I got there, I got to play with all the Red Hat products. It was, you know, kind of a a smorgasborg for an IT guy like me. Um, so you know, anything you guys are interested in talking about, I probably have some familiarity with. If not, I can definitely bring in the experts to to help out with whatever the situation

**Jason Dobyns:** Awesome.

**Jason Anderson:** is.

**Phillip Eurs:** Great. Thanks. Uh, I'm Philip Buers. I've been here at PAC for over 13 years now. So, I'm kind of the senior guy on the the Linux team here. I also work with our media um uh and content uh service team. So supporting a lot of uh uh automation or not nec sorry a lot of homegrown applications that pro do some automation uh and that's all been on Linux based platforms and we have kind of a mix of rail uh and CentOS some older

00:03:43

**Bill Venella:** Awesome.

**Phillip Eurs:** CentOS and um a few sprinklings of Oracle Linux throughout there but that's kind of uh my realm of responsibility here.

**Jason Dobyns:** I'll go next.

**Bill Venella:** Great to meet you.

**Jason Dobyns:** Uh my name is Jason Dobbins. Uh I'm almost at year two here at Panasonic. Uh I was at I was on the Toyota Racing NASCAR teams uh before coming here. Uh and uh I've worked on a lot of automation and deployment automation. Um, I'm currently working on setting up AKS and migrating a lot of our our things that run on visitor on VMs over to AKS containers. So, that's one of the things I'm going to be working on a lot this

**Sunil G:** Uh hey guys uh my name is Sunil uh I'm working here uh closely uh from 3 years

**Jason Dobyns:** year.

**Sunil G:** and I work as a you know system administrator and you know DevOps cloud engineer and S as well in my past experience. Uh that's it for me.

**Jason Anderson:** Well, nice to meet you all.

**Phillip Eurs:** And then normally normally our manager Bill Stoker would have joined the call, but he's in another meeting.

00:04:54

**Phillip Eurs:** So he might come in a little bit later. But uh as far as like interactions with the team and and questions about licensing or projects or whatever, you'll probably start conversations with me or Bill uh before we get the whole team involved.

**Bill Venella:** Okay.

**Phillip Eurs:** So with the hopes that that you should

**Bill Venella:** Good.

**Jason Anderson:** Okay,

**Bill Venella:** Yeah.

**Jason Anderson:** thank you very much.

**Bill Venella:** Yeah. Well, so you you mentioned a couple things that uh triggered some thoughts on

**Jason Anderson:** Uh

**Bill Venella:** my end, right? Uh so one was CentOS, right? So uh how are you working with them?

**Jason Dobyns:** That's

**Sunil G:** That's awesome.

**Bill Venella:** Right. Uh that's that's sort of an unsupported platform.

**Jason Dobyns:** not

**Bill Venella:** Uh are you looking at alternatives there or or are they retiring

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah,

**Bill Venella:** systems?



**Phillip Eurs:** it's a lot of older applications that were are either going to be completely replaced or refactored to supported modern platforms like Re 9 uh possibly 10, but nine is where we kind of uh uh stabilize right now uh and we do have some stuff for Oracle Linux 9 that people are using just for cost purposes because it's not mission critical stuff that we don't need support on.

00:06:12

**Phillip Eurs:** Um and then yeah like you said cents old unsupported we have um security updates through a thirdparty platform through the the Seuss uh um offering that they have.

**Jason Dobyns:** Choose Liberty Linux.

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah, which they've now switched to multilinux whatever that's mostly to to keep the gap uh

**Jason Dobyns:** Oh, yeah. Yeah.

**Phillip Eurs:** the security gap there until we can get rid of those. So we're ju just uh maintaining until we can take them out back.

**Jason Dobyns:** We we have been talking to the application owners that manage the apps on those older servers and some of the apps they run require an old version of Java and installing an old version of Java on a newer OS or newer Linux OS is not that easy sometimes. So we're we're going to look at containerizing some of those. Some of those applications, the company that created them is gone. So they don't they don't have updates coming,

**Sunil G:** Serious.

**Jason Dobyns:** but they're still in use in production um by many people here. So that's we we've we've let them know that there there is an end of life on their instances at some point in the next within like two years now because that's when that suss liberty Linux uh end of life support for those goes away and so now cyber securityurities the cyber security team is kind of involved in um checking every server running every server through through crowd strike falcon tests um things like that.

00:07:44

**Jason Dobyns:** So um if those servers don't get replaced,

**Phillip Eurs:** Help

**Jason Dobyns:** they will basic cyber security will basically give them a waiver that

**Phillip Eurs:** us enforce.

**Jason Dobyns:** only has only has a certain amount of length on it. So they that's that's something we we worked we did a bunch we did inventory on every

**Sunil G:** That's

**Jason Dobyns:** system last year and we ended up retiring many of those old systems uh a lot.

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah. A whole lot. Whole lot.

**Jason Dobyns:** Um so you know that is something we are going to keep working on um as

**Bill Venella:** Okay. So you you also mentioned moving to the cloud.

**Jason Dobyns:** well

**Bill Venella:** Uh when you retire, is it retiring or replacing with a cloud alternative?

**Jason Dobyns:** um I the answer is not no I mean a lot of VMs we launch now are straight up in Azure Azure VMs um and then we do have onrem M stuff as well for certain certain things. There's certain there's some networks that that can only be accessed from onrem devices here at some point.

00:08:52

**Jason Dobyns:** And I know that our network team is kind of working to improve that or they've been mo they've been migrating over to you know new PaloAlto firewall systems and so we'll see how that goes. But like I said we we we do have on-prem and Azure but I don't know what the count is. It's many more systems are in Azure than on prem I think or VMs.

**Bill Venella:** Yeah. Do you use real in uh in

**Phillip Eurs:** Yep.

**Jason Dobyns:** Uh yes.

**Bill Venella:** Azure?

**Jason Dobyns:** So some we use we use re I've uh created um images with packer. Um so we have a we have a we have a re 9 um I

**Phillip Eurs:** Escape.

**Jason Dobyns:** think I think I also have a rail 8 image and um then we have some Oracle 9 uh images as well and those my packer builds store them in Azure and on our onrem VMware um data store so so that if you if we want to launch anything it it basically comes with a lot of the base tooling that we want on those systems and that's part of the packer build.

00:10:02

**Bill Venella:** Okay, nice. Is there uh are you guys ha do you have any

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah.

**Bill Venella:** plans to move off of VMware?

**Phillip Eurs:** There's been discussion and evaluation and some pilot uh

**Jason Dobyns:** Yep.

**Phillip Eurs:** projects to evaluate where we're going to go because we know that the licensing costs and you know when they got bought by Broadcom things are kind of uh trending in a in a very particular direction.

**Bill Venella:** positive

**Phillip Eurs:** So yeah uh yeah the alternative uh hypervisors are definitely on the table

**Bill Venella:** way.

**Phillip Eurs:** and something that is in active research by the folks who administer that.

**Bill Venella:** Okay. Uh would you be interested in our point of view around

**Phillip Eurs:** Sure.

**Bill Venella:** that?

**Jason Dobyns:** I I think we did have some discussions but but absolutely sure.

**Phillip Eurs:** Previous team.

**Bill Venella:** Yeah.

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah.

**Bill Venella:** I mean, uh,

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah.

**Bill Venella:** depending on how long ago, we dropped a, uh, really significant update, uh, later last year that, uh, really improved and modernized, uh, our approach. So, it may be worth another look.

00:11:17

**Bill Venella:** And you know I think uh so that's technically from the business side you know what we're seeing is an opportunity to take those VMs and then you know based on what you want to do with them if you want to move them to the cloud there's a lift and shift opportunity right uh keeping them on one consistent platform all the way through allowing you to transfer those costs right so uh if you used our solution which is open shift in the data center. You could transfer the workload and the licensing to the cloud. That way it would be a transfer of cost not a duplication of costs like you currently have. So uh if that's appealing we'd love to give you a point of view. Uh so both a technical update and a you know a business update on

**Phillip Eurs:** Sure.

**Bill Venella:** that.

**Phillip Eurs:** That's probably something Bill would be interested in seeing.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah,

**Phillip Eurs:** Do you have like a um an updated white paper or kind of like a a portal site for

**Jason Dobyns:** 100%.

00:12:21

**Phillip Eurs:** digging into that yet?

**Jason Anderson:** Uh, absolutely. I'll get that to you here shortly after this meeting.

**Phillip Eurs:** Okay.

**Jason Anderson:** I'll I'll send out a recap and uh all of that good information with it.

**Phillip Eurs:** Okay.

**Jason Anderson:** Um, one thing I I want to jump in, Bill, sorry. Uh, but we have a limited amount of time here. Um, if you are serious um about a virtual the Open Shift virtualization platform, I you know, I just want to make sure I I have to go through the little sales pitch here and tell you what you're getting. That is a single platform for both uh VMs and containers. So, you're working in AKS, it's great. It's, you know, I'm sure it's awesome. Uh not knocking it, but it's only for AKS. You're never going to be able to move that same workload anywhere else without having to go through a fairly significant effort of building a new container platform, right? you're not going to be able to transfer that to EKS or back on prem very easy.

00:13:24

**Jason Anderson:** So that's Go ahead.

**Jason Dobyns:** I was say I do agree with that but we use terraform to do all the deployments and so we

**Jason Anderson:** Sorry.

**Jason Dobyns:** use they uh we use terra I use terraform to do helm deploys for any of the apps that we make so that that helm workflow basically works that's I I was all in AWS EKS over at Toyota Racing. And so I I basically use the same techniques I learned there to do the same pipelines in our GitLab to like I said, we used we have a ter I have a Helm module, a Helm Terraform module that I made that lets you use any Helm chart

and then in the TFRs for that deployment,

**Jason Anderson:** Mhm.

**Jason Dobyns:** you that's where you put any of the the values that you would normally manually set during that Helm deploy. So it's it is somewhat a little more straightforward and it doesn't matter generally on with that kind of setup to what the end deployment where it

**Jason Anderson:** conceded.

**Jason Dobyns:** goes.

**Jason Anderson:** You you picked you you have the one little uh niche point there.

00:14:31

**Phillip Eurs:** chasing.

**Jason Anderson:** I I will I will concede that point.

**Jason Dobyns:** Mhm.

**Jason Anderson:** Um for 99% of all other customers,

**Jason Dobyns:** Sure.

**Jason Anderson:** uh what I said would ring fairly true.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah,

**Jason Anderson:** Uh but regardless you know it's still once again that stable platform wherever you

**Jason Dobyns:** 100%.

**Jason Anderson:** guys are. So administration becomes easier uh development becomes easier users are used to one environment. It also gives you as you mentioned your containerizing your apps a staging ground if you want to hurry up and move everything as a VM as is today over to open shift and then work on your containerization from there. that is also a uh great workflow that we have going on for there. And I just wanted to mention all of that as you told me you were migrating stuff to AKS.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yep.

**Jason Anderson:** Um I there's a little bit of a conflict there and I I wanted to think about that because as much as I want to talk open shift with you guys, I don't want to step on any political landmines, if that makes sense.

00:15:39

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah.

**Jason Anderson:** So So

**Jason Dobyns:** I mean, learn learning some more about open the different Open Shift versions sounds great. I know it's got I know it does some it has some Kubernetes functionality as

**Jason Anderson:** Okay.

**Jason Dobyns:** well.

**Jason Anderson:** So,

**Jason Dobyns:** I know it's VMs.

**Jason Anderson:** yeah.

**Bill Venella:** Kubernetes.

**Jason Anderson:** Yeah. So,

**Bill Venella:** Yeah.

**Jason Anderson:** it all depends on the version,

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah.

**Jason Anderson:** right? We have one version that matches directly to like VMware.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yep.

**Jason Anderson:** We have another version that is a stripped down version that it's more of your vanilla Kubernetes um you know, the engine and all of that. And then we have a top tier level that gives you all the be bells and whistles uh you know developer

**Jason Dobyns:** Sure.

**Jason Anderson:** centric tools and all of that. But I would love to to schedule a deeper dive with you guys on those things. That would be that would be awesome. Um another thing that caught my attention is you said you had standardized on real 9 at this point in time.

00:16:32

**Jason Anderson:** Um, I would highly encourage uh thinking about using real 10. Um, it has been a long time since I've got excited about Linux. Like Linux has been Linux for the past 10 years. I mean, let's let's be honest, a couple things have changed with systemd and all of that.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yep.

**Jason Anderson:** But image mode with real 10 and the ability to define your OS and a DevOps workflow um as you would any other containerized application, you can treat your OS now in that exact same manner. So you're putting in immutable operating systems um you know that you can only write to very specific directories um and you know you're defining your packages that you want in that environment. So it makes things like updates and roll backs a lot easier. Um there's a lot of security

enhancements,

**Jason Dobyms:** Yep.

**Jason Anderson:** I mean AI and stuff that I can talk about as well, but I would once again that would be another topic uh that I think would be great for us to

**Jason Dobyms:** We will I will I will be adding real 10 builds sometime soon.

00:17:35

**Jason Anderson:** discuss.

**Jason Dobyms:** When I did them last year, real 10 had just been announced. It wasn't actually released yet because it was in the early part of last year. And so uh so I I might have done it towards the end of last year but I I was out since August. I came back in January. So,

**Jason Anderson:** Fair enough.

**Jason Dobyms:** but uh yeah, so adding RE 10 um the only reason we added RE 8 was again one of

**Jason Anderson:** And

**Jason Dobyms:** the one of the application owners wanted RE 8 because that was the only technically supported platform to run some software that they that we had purchased. They didn't have they didn't have rail 9 or 10 or it was only real 8 and other versions of Linux. So that's that's why we did that's why we built a couple of rele um VMs as

**Jason Anderson:** Okay. Like I said, I mean,

**Jason Dobyms:** well.

**Jason Anderson:** a lot of customers that I've talked to are just now, you know, they do the every other release or something like that.

00:18:38

**Jason Anderson:** Um, if if that was your cycle,

**Jason Dobyms:** Sure.

**Jason Anderson:** you know, once again, this is an intro call. Um, I wanted to make sure you were aware of that.

**Jason Dobyms:** Yep.

**Jason Anderson:** Um,

**Jason Dobyms:** I mean we're we're adding a lot of we're adding a lot of um work not

workflows but we're adding a lot of Terraform usage. Um, so almost every VM in Azure now is being imported to Terraform if it was not created with it at first. And every new thing created is using our Terraform modules. So, and we're trying to get basically standardize the process to set up a new machine. Um, you know, everyone clicked them into existence in Azure for the first few years here. And it's some of some of them are it's not a quick thing. you got to click, you got to in their UI, you'd click hundreds of times before it was done. So having our modu our Terraform modules basically ready to go pretty much does all of that heavy lifting and gets us onto that workflow that's pretty much the same.

00:19:43

**Jason Dobyns:** You know, some yes, there will be some differences, how many discs, what size of the discs, what size of the VM, um things like that. So, but yeah, so like I said, real 10 is going to be added sometime soon. Um, I was actually just looking earlier at the Red Hat um the Red Hat uh versions of of their Docker containers. So that because uh one of the next workflows I want to migrate is um our yum repository mirror that I have set up and I have that set up on a VM. But it and that the only reason for that at first was it required Red Hat 9. It required the Red Hat 9 system to be properly um properly added to you know our our account and then it could run the same command.

**Jason Anderson:** Mhm.

**Jason Dobyns:** But then they're only served over it's basically static files. It's only engine X serving static files and then we point all of our VMs there. So I'm I'm going to try to get those into AKS sometime soon as well.

00:20:49

**Jason Anderson:** Okay.

**Phillip Eurs:** And one thing you'll learn working with us uh as a customer, we are uh sometimes handcuffed by uh the engineers who have made uh uh decisions and made platforms that uh they did not keep up with. So, when we mention the older stuff, the CentOS or not CentOS, the Rail 8, um that's not uncommon around here, but we we're doing what we can to to get rid of it.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah. Um,

**Phillip Eurs:** Uh we're for an engineering company and people like to roll and had been able to roll



**Jason Dobyns:** no. Go ahead.

**Phillip Eurs:** their own stuff uh without without earlier controls. Uh and it's a culture that we've been reinforcing for you know proper process, proper projects, proper uh um deployments and it's it's been a fight with some of the some of the teams but it's getting better and that means that we can also maintain

**Jason Anderson:** Why why do

**Phillip Eurs:** uh uh modern platforms rather than limp along on old stuff.

**Jason Anderson:** you want me to change anything?

**Jason Dobyns:** Oh my

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah, it's working.

00:21:56

**Jason Dobyns:** god.

**Phillip Eurs:** Don't touch it.

**Jason Anderson:** You know, as somebody who, like I said, who spent 14 years supporting the FAA? I can tell you personally, um, I came to Red Hat four years ago. So in 2022, they were implementing stuff that we tested and researched in 2015. It took them seven years to start rolling out stuff that is now already

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah.

**Jason Anderson:** outdated. So believe me,

**Jason Dobyns:** H.

**Jason Anderson:** I get

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah.

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah.

**Jason Dobyns:** I I

**Phillip Eurs:** And FAA,

**Jason Anderson:** it.

**Jason Dobyns:** mean

**Phillip Eurs:** you mentioned, I mean, we we build inflight entertainment systems for the aircraft. So, everything that we put on there has to go through FAA layers of approvals and all that. So,

**Jason Anderson:** This

**Phillip Eurs:** we're very familiar with the the glacial pace of certain

**Jason Dobyns:** And it's not just it's not just the latest versions where there's like seven or eight generations of those in-flight entertainment and internet services still flying. And so some of those older systems still rely on much older services.

00:22:55

**Jason Dobyns:** And like I said, it's so we we have a we have a process that if there's some if there's anything that's in use by stuff actually, you know, in the air, it's it takes a lot of people to check off and be like, "Okay, we can we can move this." So, you know, it's it is definitely a process.

**Bill Venella:** Highly regulated.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah. Yep.

**Jason Anderson:** So, all right, J and my last question because I'm hogging all the time and I apologize. Uh, Jason, you mentioned your project for mining uh migrating everything to AKS that you can. Are there any other big initiatives going on with you guys this year that um you know we might be able to help out with or think

**Jason Dobyns:** Um, I I don't think the answer is no,

**Jason Anderson:** through?

**Jason Dobyns:** but some some of the other stuff we've kind of got going on is us taking over things from one of our one of our co-workers uh left recently. And so we're we're we've been learning about we've been adding uh Phil's been adding people to to some of these other environments that only Phil and Jim used to have access to.

00:24:03

**Jason Dobyns:** So he's adding myself and Sil and teaching us how things work in those and those are like on the media content system or team sides of things. So, you know, there's there's a lot of that and that's more internal um introduction to these other networks, these other systems that we have here and how Phil gets the work done. And if we can help, we will, you know. So,

**Phillip Eurs:** I do want to implement a lot more automation and and um modernization in that environment,

**Jason Anderson:** Copy.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yep.

**Phillip Eurs:** but that is a very locked down uh almost airgapped uh environment. So it may it has its own set of challenges,

**Jason Dobyns:** Mhm.

**Phillip Eurs:** but we we'll get there a little at a

**Jason Anderson:** What is your automation tool of choice?

**Jason Dobyns:** Ansible.

**Jason Anderson:** Your answerable.

**Jason Dobyns:** We we use Ansible a good amount. Um like I said, we've been adding since I've been here, we've been adding a lot more stuff with Terraform. That's one of my core skills. And that's because there's a lot of things once you learn to do Terraform.

00:25:10

**Jason Dobyns:** They're very similar modules that work in different places. So, so the the you know setting having a module that can set up a Linux VM

**Jason Anderson:** Mhm.

**Jason Dobyns:** uh on prem or in AKS or or not AKS, Azure or even AWS. It's it's just slight differences uh in the in the Terraform setup, but a lot of the base parts of the module are pretty similar.

**Jason Anderson:** Okay. So, and I'm not, you know, once again, Terraform's awesome. Been there, done that. Um, do have you ever used Ansible in your ter or Ansible to launch your Terraform workflows and combine Terraform and Ansible together? Um,

**Jason Dobyns:** Not directly.

**Jason Anderson:** because that is that is now supported in uh AAP2.6.

**Jason Dobyns:** No.

**Jason Anderson:** So, um, might be something worth checking out. There has been a lot of work uh since IBM acquired Hashi um to, you know, better bring together uh bring the better together story with you know terraform and anible and vault integration as well if you guys are doing thirdparty secret management.

00:26:22

**Jason Dobyns:** Sure.

**Jason Anderson:** Um once again something you know if you would like to explore further be happy to set up some meetings

**Jason Dobyns:** Absolutely. Uh,

**Jason Anderson:** for

**Jason Dobyns:** one of one of my tickets I have coming up in the next couple of sprints is updating Anible and Terraform to the latest versions because we have been using much older versions and the modules that they use have already given us some warnings for things that are going to be deprecated in the provider module the provider um for

Terraform

**Jason Anderson:** Okay.

**Jason Dobyns:** for things like Azure. So we will be running through that and I don't expect any huge code changes needed but we'll we'll we'll run through them when we get there. And so same thing like I said with Ansible too. We're running an older version, Ansible hasn't been updated in I don't know like a few years when I first started. I I've got it.

**Jason Anderson:** Are you are you tower or post

**Jason Dobyns:** Sorry I don't

**Jason Anderson:** tower?

**Bill Venella:** What version are

00:27:26

**Jason Dobyns:** tower.

**Bill Venella:** you?

**Jason Dobyns:** Uh hold on.

**Phillip Eurs:** I don't think we're using power. Maybe someone on the GCS site is, but I don't think we are.

**Jason Dobyns:** I don't think so either. Uh going to look at

**Jason Anderson:** Well, I mean, if you're using tower, it's no longer supported. So, that was kind of why I asked that question. Um, because if you are, we we really need to discuss an upgrade path for you.

**Phillip Eurs:** I got replaced by AAP, right?

**Jason Anderson:** Yes.

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah, I think we are.

**Phillip Eurs:** I don't think

**Jason Dobyns:** I mean, like I said, I know our version that we use is older.

**Jason Anderson:** Um, another topic I should probably get you guys in front of one of our principal architects to talk about 2.6. Um, AAP. There's all kinds of new stuff. Um, including integration with AI, um, event-driven automation. I don't know if you've heard about that, but that's the one I got excited about.

00:28:32

**Jason Anderson:** um integrates with your alerting systems. Um so if an alert comes in, it'll activate what we call a rule book, otherwise you know formerly known as a playbook in traditional ansible. that rulebook will define the actions that it wants to take based off the error that is received and then you can have it either generate automation um and at that point I would suggest putting it in a service now uh ticket you know and having somebody review it. I would never encourage anybody to run untested automation on a production machine. So please don't do that bad. Um, but those are some of the cool new features that uh can come along with AAP as well. So, it sounds like to me like there's a lot of, you know, at minimum um catchup to do for you guys on some of the latest and greatest Red Hat stuff.

**Jason Dobyns:** We're on Ansible 2.12.

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah.

**Jason Dobyns:** So,

**Jason Anderson:** Yeah.

**Jason Dobyns:** I know that's not the newest version,

**Jason Anderson:** Yeah.

**Jason Dobyns:** but it's um so that's like I said, it's one of the things I'm going to have coming up sometime soon to update all of our a lot of our tooling to the latest ones and then setting up things that will continually update those those containers because the containers that have those tools or what the pipeline jobs run in. So I will be going through a process to have those continually update um so regular updates and that's one side for the tooling to be updated but the other

00:30:11

**Jason Dobyns:** side is so that anything that's running like that would have um recent updates within like a week or a month so that the cyber security scans um are our our overall cyber security scores should go closer to 100. We're not there yet, but there's a lot of stuff this older stuff that it just needs to be updated. And it's it's much easier to do that on the newer platforms where they they're using containers and things because then the the underlying hosts are somewhat not not irrelevant, but they're easily replaceable when there is a update at the OS level that they run on. So

**Jason Anderson:** I mean to me you just described the beauty of Kubernetes and operators.

**Jason Dobyns:** yeah.

**Jason Anderson:** Um,

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah.

**Jason Anderson:** I mean to be very blunt that's literally what you just described to me is I have I have this great tool that is going to sit here and listen to every instance and when there's an update I'm going to roll it

**Jason Dobyns:** Yep.

**Jason Anderson:** out if you give me permission otherwise you can test and validate and then I'm going to roll it out.

00:31:19

**Jason Anderson:** But otherwise every ver every instance is going to be the same version.

**Jason Dobyns:** Yeah,

**Jason Anderson:** So it makes management way easier.

**Jason Dobyns:** I mean it's it's just it it changes the focus away from how do we how do we update these longived servers with replacing them with servers that can be replaced like at any time and in that replacing process the service itself doesn't go down.

**Jason Anderson:** Get down.

**Jason Dobyns:** it it migrates the pod ingress traffic immediately goes to the new pod on the on the host that's already been updated and it goes through and does the rest of them in the AKS cluster so or just Kubernetes cluster so like I said it's it it removes the it removes the requirement of having these VMs that can't be replaced with a newer version of the OS Um,

**Jason Anderson:** Nice.

**Jason Dobyns:** now like I said that some of those apps require an older version of Java and we I I did try to help get them updated but there it wouldn't run. Older Java was not easy to install on the newer versions of

00:32:31

**Jason Anderson:** Yeah,

**Jason Dobyns:** Linux and like it's

**Jason Anderson:** completely makes sense.

**Jason Dobyns:** not it's not a recently old version of Jamaa.

**Jason Anderson:** Um,

**Jason Dobyns:** It's like many years old at this point for some of

**Jason Anderson:** uh, so, Bill, I'm going to apologize. I have completely geeked out and gone in a hundred different directions here on this phone call.

**Jason Dobyns:** them.

**Jason Anderson:** Um, I'm going to really push it back to you to close this

**Bill Venella:** Yeah, I mean I think uh what we we are here to offer

**Jason Anderson:** out.

**Bill Venella:** is uh a tighter relationship, a tighter partnership and uh if you guys are open uh two things, right? So one, I'd love to build some consistency into uh these type of meetings. Uh and then two, I'd love to understand more about your current architecture and plans and then that'll help us develop a plan to help support you better. Right? So, uh because we are opensource, a lot of our products have tools built into them that uh are

**Jason Dobyns:** Sure.

**Bill Venella:** free to use in addition to what you're already using.

00:33:41

**Bill Venella:** And you know so if we had an understanding of your architecture and your goals we could help you understand you know better ways to implement our technology and save you some money right so if you guys are open to that uh uh we would be also

**Phillip Eurs:** Sure, we can set up a a standing probably a monthly uh cadence here once we get sorted or settled in on you know you understanding our our roadmap. Um I know that our renewal uh for licensing is coming up and we're getting that started with our vendor uh and so you guys will probably see that come through pretty soon. uh we are definitely not reducing our our Red Hat footprint at the moment. So, you know, we'll we'll have reasons to

**Bill Venella:** Okay. Excellent.

**Phillip Eurs:** talk.

**Bill Venella:** Who who do you uh currently use as a bar?

**Jason Anderson:** Sounds good.

**Phillip Eurs:** Our bar is shi.

**Bill Venella:** SHI. Okay.

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah.

**Bill Venella:** Uh and so I guess you'll be sharing updated counts with them. We'll go through the updated quoting process.

00:34:50

**Bill Venella:** But yeah,

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah.

**Bill Venella:** you know, I I guess my commitment to you is I want to understand more about your business so that I can help you understand how to get some more value out of Red

**Phillip Eurs:** Sure.

**Jason Dobyns:** Good morning.

**Phillip Eurs:** Well,

**Bill Venella:** Hat.

**Phillip Eurs:** we can set up another chat and hopefully that one we can have our manager join in too. Uh because he's got a little bit more of the strategic bigger picture and could probably offer some insights from higher up the chain

**Bill Venella:** Awesome.

**Phillip Eurs:** than than us here.

**Jason Anderson:** Awesome.

**Bill Venella:** So, so last question to you will be where is everybody based?

**Jason Dobyns:** Nope.

**Bill Venella:** Is everybody based centrally in one

**Jason Anderson:** And

**Bill Venella:** place?

**Phillip Eurs:** Yeah, we are are uh here in Irvine, California uh in Orange County.

**Bill Venella:** Okay.

**Phillip Eurs:** I'm I can throw my pen and hit Jason in the back of the head if I wanted to.

**Jason Dobyns:** f\*\*\*.

**Phillip Eurs:** Uh I'm not going to, but uh but yeah, so we're here West Coast and uh we we do three days in the office and two days at home. So some days when we're meeting you'll see us in our in our our personal spaces,

**Jason Anderson:** All

**Phillip Eurs:** but uh Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, we're right here in Irvine.

**Bill Venella:** Okay, excellent. So, in the future, I would also like to get out there again, spend some more time, you know, share a meal uh and and start building that relationship.

**Phillip Eurs:** Sounds good to

**Bill Venella:** All right. Well, excellent.

**Phillip Eurs:** me.

**Bill Venella:** It was great to meet you guys.

**Jason Anderson:** right.



**Bill Venella:** Uh definitely looking forward to uh continuing the conversation.

**Jason Dobyns:** Very nice to meet you guys as

**Bill Venella:** Um yeah, so we'll we'll wait to hear back from you.

**Jason Dobyns:** well.

**Bill Venella:** Uh Jason, I mean we'll we'll share the notes from today and then offer you some ideas on you know from our side tracks,

**Jason Anderson:** I I'll also add a little bit of information about the different flavors of Open Shift.

**Bill Venella:** right?

**Jason Dobyns:** Sure.

Transcription ended after 00:36:58

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